

My Learning Workflow

For technical/coding courses with daily reading + daily exercises. Goal: actually apply what I learn and retain it long-term, without wasting time on notes.

The Daily Loop (~60–90 min)

1. **Fast read of today's topic** (~15 min). One pass. No notes, no highlights. Just orient.
2. **Open the exercises and start.** Even if I feel unready. Attempt them. Hit walls.
3. **Re-read only what the walls force me to.** Go back to the specific section I need. Editor open. Try things.
4. **Finish the exercises.**
5. **Two-minute capture in lessons.md.** Only what surprised me today. If nothing surprised me, write nothing.
6. **One line in course-index.md.** Day X: [topic] - [key thing].

Close laptop.

Weekly Check-in (15 min, end of week)

- Pick the exercise that felt shakiest.
 - Redo one small piece of it from memory, no looking.
 - If it works → internalized. If not → that's the weekend revisit.
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What Goes Where

lessons.md — the only real “notes”

Three categories, nothing else:

- **Gotcha** — something that tripped me up.
- **Mental model** — a one-line intuition that clicked.
- **Snippet** — small reusable pattern + one comment on why.

Aim: 0–2 lines per day. 5–15 lines per week max. If it's longer, I'm transcribing instead of distilling.

course-index.md — navigation, not content

One line per day. A searchable map of the whole course.

Exercise folder

The completed exercises ARE the notes. One-line comment at the top of each, saying what it taught me.

The Rules (the parts that fail if I skip them)

Do

- ✓ Attempt exercises **before** I feel ready.
- ✓ Predict the answer in my head before solving — wrong predictions are the actual learning moment.
- ✓ Capture only **after** building, never during reading.

Don't

- ✗ No transcribing the reading.
- ✗ No chapter summaries “for later.”
- ✗ No flashcards for syntax.
- ✗ No reformatting notes to look pretty.

The One-liner

Read fast, attempt before ready, re-read only what walls force, capture only what surprised me.